



FREE GUIDE · FOR FQHCs & COMMUNITY HEALTH CENTERS

# The FQHC / Health Center's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Medical, dental, behavioral, pharmacy — the full  
range of regulated waste, on a tight budget.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

## Every stream, under one roof.

FQHCs and community health centers deliver comprehensive care — often medical, dental, behavioral health, and pharmacy under one roof — so you generate the full range of regulated waste: sharps, pharmaceutical (including expired 340B stock), controlled substances, and biohazard. And you do it on a tight, grant-funded budget. This guide covers every stream, affordably.

### The good news

One DEA-registered vendor can handle every stream your center produces — sharps, pharma (including 340B), controls, and biohazard — with no contract, no minimums, and buy-as-you-need pricing that fits a grant budget.

### AT A GLANCE

## Who regulates what.

| Agency | What it covers in your practice                                                         |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OSHA   | Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training. |
| EPA    | RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.     |
| DEA    | Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.      |
| DOT    | Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.                 |
| State  | Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.                           |

### THE STREAMS

## Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

### WASTE STREAM 01

## Sharps

Injection, vaccine, dental, and lab sharps across departments.

#### GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Injection & vaccine sharps
- Dental & lab sharps
- Lancets & syringes

#### DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

**THE RULE** · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

**DISPOSE WITH** · Sharps mail-back kit.

#### Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

### WASTE STREAM 02

## Pharmaceutical waste

Expired medications, including 340B program stock.

#### GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired 340B & non-controlled meds
- Discontinued medications
- Samples

#### DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

**THE RULE** · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

**DISPOSE WITH** · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

#### Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

### WASTE STREAM 03

## Controlled substances

Controlled substances from medical and behavioral health.

#### GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V meds
- Wasted & partial doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

#### DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

**THE RULE** · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

**DISPOSE WITH** · Controlled / medication mail-back kit, to DEA standards.

#### Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

#### WASTE STREAM 04

## Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Regulated medical waste across medical and dental.

#### GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked gauze & dressings
- Extracted teeth (per state) & dental biohazard
- Contaminated PPE

#### DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

**THE RULE** · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

**DISPOSE WITH** · Biohazard mail-back kit.

#### Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

#### YOUR CHECKLIST

## The FQHC compliance checklist.

- ☐ Sharps from every department in FDA-cleared containers.
- ☐ Expired meds — including 340B stock — destroyed as pharmaceutical waste with documentation.
- ☐ Controlled substances rendered non-retrievable with a Form 41.

- ☐ Medical and dental biohazard red-bagged and destroyed.
- ☐ Amalgam captured and recycled if you have a dental program (never incinerated).
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per HRSA, state, and grant rules.

#### QUESTIONS HEALTH CENTERS ASK

## Your FQHC questions, answered.

### How do we dispose of expired 340B medications?

As pharmaceutical waste, destroyed with documentation — segregating any controlled or hazardous drugs first. We'll help you keep records clean for audits.

### Can one vendor cover medical, dental, and behavioral health?

Yes — one program covers sharps, pharma, controls, and biohazard across every department, with unified documentation.

### We're on a tight grant budget — do we have to commit?

No — no contract and no minimums. Buy kits as you need them, which keeps costs predictable and grant-friendly.

### Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

#### THE EASY WAY

## Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle covers every stream an FQHC produces — sharps, pharma (including 340B), controls, and biohazard — by mail-back or scheduled pickup, with Form 41 handled and Certificates of Destruction. No contract, no minimums — built for a grant budget.

#### QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

| Waste stream               | The right path                        |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Sharps (all departments)   | Sharps mail-back kit                  |
| Expired meds / 340B        | Pharmaceutical waste kit              |
| Controlled substances      | Controlled / medication kit (Form 41) |
| Medical & dental biohazard | Biohazard mail-back kit               |

**Prefer pickup, or higher volume?**

Multi-department centers often mix mail-back with scheduled pickup — we'll build a budget-friendly program. Get a quote at [easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote](https://easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote) or call 501-904-2929.

**WHY FQHCs & COMMUNITY HEALTH CENTERS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE**

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

**Ready to simplify your community health center waste?**

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · [sales@easyrxcycle.com](mailto:sales@easyrxcycle.com) · [easyrxcycle.com/shop](https://easyrxcycle.com/shop)